

Chicago Tribune



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WEDNESDAY, APRIL 9, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Progress hazy for diversity in CPD

Amid department goal, results dependent on how officers are counted

By Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

Who wants to be a cop in Chicago?

Who gets to be a cop in Chicago?

Mayor Brandon Johnson told reporters last month that working toward long-standing goals to diversify the Chicago Police Department, the city has seen an increase in CPD applications from communities of color.

"We're seeing positive results where we have a diverse workforce, our Police Department is becoming more and more diverse," Johnson said.

"Interesting unknown fact people should know: There are more Latino individuals that are applying for these positions. There are more, still, Black candidates who are applying for these positions," he added. "I believe that type of diversity is important. Almost 30% of the workforce are women in our Police Department. This is not the '80s Police Department, right?"

But what the mayor did not mention is how those groups are counted and the rate at which different applicant categories are hired.

From the start of 2023 through the end of 2024, the city received more than 52,000 job applications from people seeking to join the ranks of the Chicago Police Department — an average of 500 applications per week for two years — according to city hiring data obtained by the Tribune.

In that time, CPD hired 2,301 people.

Of those brought onto the force, 979 identified as Hispanic/Latino, 945 applicants identified as white, 537 identified as Black, 104 identified as Asian, data show. But while the figures suggest progress on the

Turn to Diversity, Page 2



Senate President Don Harmon leads other state senators into the House chamber before Gov. JB Pritzker's State of the State address on Feb. 19 at the Illinois State Capitol in Springfield. BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Election board: Harmon improperly took \$4M

Illinois Senate president accepted more in political contributions than allowed

By Addison Wright and Ray Long
Chicago Tribune

Illinois Democratic Senate President Don Harmon improperly accepted \$4 million more in political contributions than allowed under campaign donation laws he championed years ago, according to the State Board of Elections.

In a certified letter sent to Harmon last month following a Chicago Tribune inquiry about Harmon's fundraising, state election officials said his campaign

committee accepted numerous donations within nine months after the March 2024 primary that far exceeded state contribution caps designed to curtail big-money influence in Illinois politics.

A spokesman for the Oak Park Democrat confirmed Harmon's main political campaign fund received the board's letter but gave little other immediate reaction.

"We are reviewing this communication with our attorneys and look forward to resolving this matter," Harmon political

spokesman Tom Bowen said.

Harmon has until April 18 to return the campaign cash above the limits "to the contributor or donate an equal amount to charity" or to the state's general fund, the letter said. Or the fund could potentially face a fine of more than \$6.1 million, which is the 150% penalty the state statute calls for against campaign committees that willfully accept contributions over the limit, the letter said.

The likelihood of such a massive penalty, however, is slim. Politicians often success-

fully appeal elections board violations or reach settlements with the board, which is well-known for having minimal enforcement powers. Despite the strong language of the letter, board spokesman Matt Dietrich said election officials view the Harmon matter as only an allegation at this point.

Harmon's aggressive fundraising and the state board's response underscore Illinois' porous campaign finance structure more than 15 years after the

Turn to Harmon, Page 4

NBA referee Crawford named to Hall of Fame

Longtime Naperville resident has spent 32 seasons in the league

By Tess Kenny
Naperville Sun

Danny Crawford is used to making the calls, not calling attention to himself. But in his case, one begets the other.

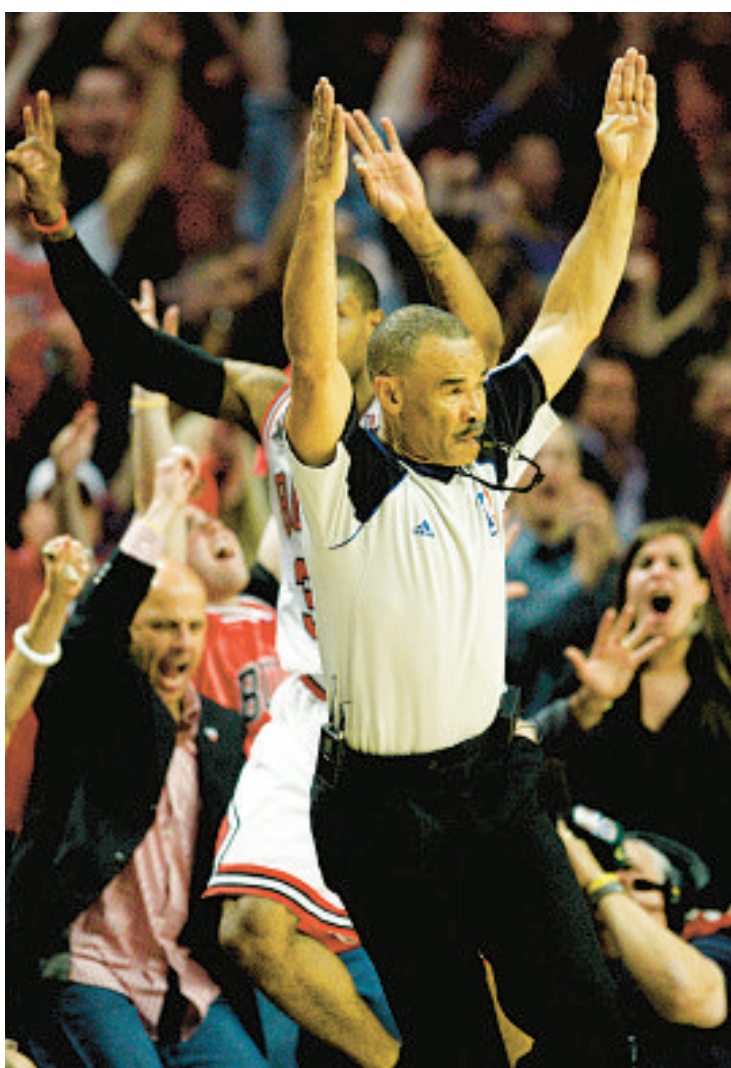
After 32 seasons spent as one of the NBA's most respected officials, Crawford — a longtime Naperville resident — is headed to the Naismith Basketball Hall of Fame. He was tapped for enshrinement Saturday as part of the organization's Class of 2025.

Reached by phone Monday, Crawford said he was honored — and shocked.

"When you're a referee, you do your job and you just move on to the next game," he said. "Getting attention is foreign to us."

Alongside Crawford, Chicago Bulls coach and two-time NCAA champion Billy Donovan and former Chicago Sky star Sylvia

Turn to Crawford, Page 2



Referee Danny Crawford signals for a three-point goal after Bulls point guard C.J. Watson scores during the fourth quarter against the Miami Heat in Game 1 of the Eastern Conference Finals at the United Center on May 15, 2011. CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Tariffs sending tremors through auto industry

Trump's 25% levies felt already as factories idled and imports cut

By Jack Ewing
The New York Times

President Donald Trump's 25% tariffs on imported vehicles, which went into effect last week, are already sending tremors through the auto industry, prompting companies to stop shipping cars to the United States, shut down factories in Canada and Mexico and lay off workers in Michigan and other states.

Jaguar Land Rover, based in Britain, said it would temporarily stop exporting its luxury cars to the United States. Stellantis idled factories in Canada and Mexico that make Chrysler and Jeep vehicles and laid off 900 U.S. workers who supply those factories with engines and other parts.

Audi, the luxury division of Volkswagen, also paused exports of cars to the United States from Europe, telling dealers to sell whatever they still had on their lots.

If other carmakers make similar moves, the economic impact could be severe, leading to higher car prices and widespread



Land Rovers sit Monday on a Houston dealership lot. Further imports have been "paused." RONALDO SCHEMIDT/GETTY-AFP

IN NATION & WORLD: Senators push for answers on tariffs.

layoffs. The tariffs on cars are among the first of several industry-specific levies that Trump has in his sights and could offer early clues about how businesses will respond to his trade policies, including whether they raise prices or increase manufacturing in the United States. The president has said he also wants to tax imported medicines and computer chips.

Applying the new tariff to imported cars could increase their cost to consumers by thousands of dollars, sharply reducing

Turn to Tariffs, Page 10

Bears coach 'setting the tone'

Several players talked Tuesday of feeling Ben Johnson's intensity and confidence. There also was an underlying understanding that the work starts now. **Chicago Sports**

Mayor to jump-start budget talks

Brandon Johnson is promising alderman an early start to hammering out a new budget after he suffered setbacks in the process last fall. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Stoked for smoked meats

M'daKhan, a Middle Eastern restaurant in Bridgeview's Little Palestine, features halal smoked and grilled meats, food by way of backyard barbecues. **Food & Health**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 44 Low 37

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 16

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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